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TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 10, 2026

Immigration raids, fear, and empty desks

Federal sweeps, violence prompt spike in number of students absent from class

15 MILLION MISSED DAYS

Third in a three-part series

By Marcela Rodrigues and Christopher Huffaker
GLOBE STAFF

Ana Michelle Ramirez Sanan had momentum her senior year at Chelsea High. With a 3.3 grade-point average, the first-generation US citizen was heading to college to study mechanical engineering, succeeding when so many students around her were falling behind.

But that was before the Trump administration unleashed an indiscriminate crackdown on immigrants, and like many young people on the periphery, Ramirez became collateral damage.

On Sept. 26 last year, she witnessed federal agents slam her mother to a sidewalk, her head bouncing off the concrete. Bystander video showed an ICE officer kneeling on her 50-year-old mother's back and twisting her wrists into handcuffs, even though she had lived in Massachusetts legally for 25 years.

Officers confirmed her mother's legal residency and let her go, but the episode upended Ramirez's senior year as she grappled with debilitating anxiety and her mother's lingering injuries. The accomplished student missed five weeks of school, arrived late another 40 days, and saw her grade-point average fall by nearly a full point.

The federal immigration sweep that ensnared the Ramirez family did more than detain 1,400 people across Massachusetts. It unleashed fear across immigrant communities, leaving desks empty in schools across the state because parents have been afraid to send their children to school.

During the raids in September of 2025, absences spiked in Chelsea Public Schools, hitting a peak for the month, with 12 percent of kids missing.

That same immigration crackdown — dubbed Operation Patriot 2.0 — hit Milford, where the dozens of arrests in September included a 16-year-old high school sophomore. In the days that followed, more than 400 Milford students missed school, making it the worst attendance

SCHOOL, Page A10

Density divide emerges on Question 7

Towns closer to Boston backed measure, others farther away opposed it

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

It was only a few years ago that the residents of Lexington declared their community an unlikely leader in the state's daunting quest to dig out of its deep housing affordability crisis, passing an ambitious plan to boost multifamily development in key parts of the town.

As it turns out, the historic town's support for new housing was not quite so straightforward. Voters there last week rejected Question 7, the ballot measure that would have set a state minimum of land needed to build a single-family home in Massachusetts in a bid to boost the production of so-called starter homes.

Question 7 - Reduce minimum lot sizes for single-family homes

50.6%
No

49.4%
Yes

Like in many other communities outside of Boston's urban core, Lexington residents were broadly reluctant to let go of local authority over the look and feel of their neighborhoods. A patchwork of municipal restrictions on land use across the state has helped exacerbate the crisis, but the narrow failure of Question 7 last week demonstrates the difficult town-by-town challenge of building the homes Massachusetts needs.

"There were good intentions behind this proposal," said Lin Jensen, a Lexington Planning Board member. "But places like Lexington are

QUESTION 7, Page A10

Inside the final days of the 'Jays'

As ex-teammates prepare to face off, what happened?

By Gary Washburn
GLOBE STAFF

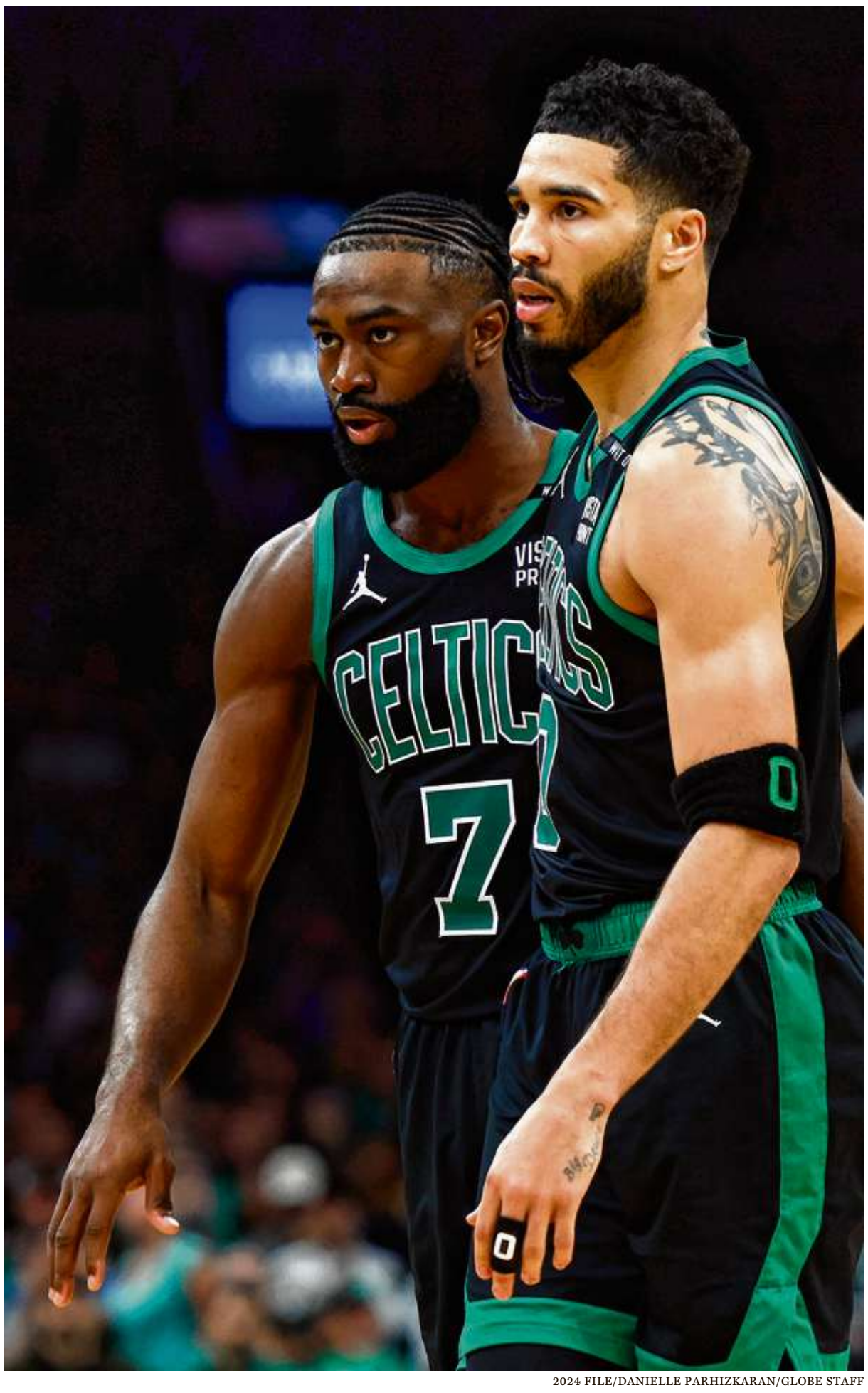
The final encounter between Jayson Tatum and Jaylen Brown as Celtics was fitting. It occurred in late June at the Cannes Sports Beach Event afterparty in the French Riviera, which both players coincidentally attended on the eve of Brown's trade to the 76ers.

When informed that Tatum was in the vicinity, Brown asked to share a VIP table with Hall of Famer Carmelo Anthony, indicating it might be best to hang out with him and his group instead.

The silence and lack of interaction between the two Celtics greats — who spent nine seasons together, won a championship, and reached another NBA Finals — was an apt end to their tenure as teammates. Brown was on the trading block, Tatum had stayed out of the situation, and their near-decade-long partnership was about to end without a final conversation.

"I thought [Brown] felt awkward about something going on," Antho-

TEAMMATES, Page C4



2024 FILE/DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Some in the Celtics organization noticed the relationship between Jaylen Brown (left) and Jayson Tatum began to change after the 2024 NBA Finals.

Hegseth assails 'toxic' ideas in R.I. speech

In D.C., lawmaker moves to impeach defense secretary

By Edward Fitzpatrick, Christopher Gavin, Jackie Kucinich, and Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

NEWPORT, R.I. — Monday was a split-screen day for Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth.

In Newport, he visited the Naval War College and derided the "toxic and destructive ideas," including racial and gender diversity, that have destroyed "the warrior ethos," a variation on the typical themes he's made central to his tenure.

Four hundred miles away in Washington, D.C., Republican Representative Thomas Massie moved to force a vote to impeach him, introducing a resolution largely focused on the war Hegseth has carried out for President Trump in Iran, a major source of voter ire in the drubbing they delivered congressional Republicans in last week's midterm

HEGSETH, Page A7

Sign of the times

Tuesday: Partly sunny, cool. High 55-60. Low 45-50.
Wednesday: Much the same. High 53-58. Low 42-47.
Sunrise: 6:29 Sunset: 4:27
Obituaries, **C9**
Comics and Weather, **D5-6**

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Jurors said they were deadlocked in the federal trial of Matthew Farwell, who is accused of killing Sandra Birchmore, but the judge asked them to return Tuesday. **B1.**

A judge denied Lindsay Clancy's petition to dismiss murder charges against her and also rejected a request by her lawyers to conduct a limited inquiry into the holdout juror. **B4.**

Congress returned to a changed Washington, as President Trump doubled down on his political threats despite landmark GOP losses. **A2.**

Mayor Michelle Wu's administration said it was prepared to loosen Boston's affordable housing requirements for developers in order to spur more construction. **D1.**

Talks to end the war in Ukraine are set to resume Tuesday after a nine-month lull. **A5.**

A billboard-sized gap in pristine scenery

Mass. and N.H. have not copied bans in Vermont, Maine for ad-less views

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

REPORTER'S NOTEBOOK

In October, I had the privilege of taking long drives through the northern New England states during the height of fall foliage. Maine was spectacular. Vermont was just showing off.

Yet it was in New Hampshire, home to perhaps the most stunning geography in New England, that I asked myself why that state felt . . . different. Less visually pristine than its neighbors, even when the vistas said otherwise.

Nothing against New Hampshire, as the feeling only got worse when I crossed the line back into Massachusetts. But I still couldn't put my finger on what it was.

Then, suddenly, it smacked me in the face,

BILLBOARDS, Page A7



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

A billboard was changed in the early morning sun in East Boston in 2023.